



A new tool to target migrants: Databases

Officials comb private information to boot people from homes, jobs

BY RACHEL SIEGEL,
HANNAH NATANSON
AND LAURA MECKLER

The Trump administration is using personal data normally protected from dissemination to find undocumented immigrants where they work, study and live, often with the goal of removing them from their housing and the workforce.

At the Department of Housing and Urban Development, for example, officials are working on a rule that would ban mixed-status households — in which some family members have legal status and others don't — from public housing, according to multiple staffers who spoke on the condition of anonymity out of fear of retribution. Affiliates from the U.S. DOGE Service are also looking to kick out existing mixed-status households, vowing to ensure that undocumented immigrants do not benefit from public programs, even if they live with citizens or other eligible family members.

The push extends across agencies: Last week, the Social Security Administration entered the

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Social Security data: How DOGE is trying to defy a court order. **A2**

DOGE: Group seeks to put agents into independent nonprofit. **A12**

Law firms see peril in deals with president

Institutions in Trump's sights risk resignations, erosion of profession

BY MARK BERMAN

In the weeks since President Donald Trump began hammering some powerful law firms with significant punishments and cutting deals with others, the legal industry has been bitterly divided on how to respond and deeply worried about the showdown's repercussions.

Trump's sanctions and some firms' decisions to strike deals with him have shaken the profession, with attorneys across the country grappling with fear, outrage, anxiety and uncertainty. Attorneys at some law firms that reached agreements with Trump have quit in protest, while others have debated whether to make the same move.

"People are despondent," said an attorney who used to work at a firm that struck a deal with Trump. "It is devastating to all of us. Nobody really knows what to do."

Since February, Trump has been targeting several high-profile firms that challenged his policies or had ties to his perceived enemies, signing executive orders stripping them of government contracts and banning their attorneys from federal buildings. Some

SEE LAW FIRMS ON A12



GUY PETERSON/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Babana Mohamed, a meteorite broker, looks through a magnifying glass at a possible meteorite in Nouakchott, Mauritania, in January.

On the hunt for meteorites in the far reaches of the Sahara

Nomadic herders in the Mauritanian desert search for unusual rocks from space, hoping to find riches

BY RACHEL CHASON, GUY PETERSON,
ELY CHEIKH MOHAMED VADEL AND WILSON McMakin
IN BIR MOGHREIN, MAURITANIA

You may have seen a meteorite before, even if you didn't know it.

Nearly 100,000 pounds of meteoritic matter enters Earth's atmosphere every day, scientists estimate. The vast majority burns up as it hurtles through the sky, creating shooting stars.

Of the few space rocks that fall to Earth, most end up in the ocean. The rest mostly go unnoticed, blending in with other stones.

But in the Mauritanian desert, herders have learned what to look for: rocks with a strikingly dark surface, known as the fusion crust. Though meteorites fall with the same frequency around the world, scientists say, they are especially easy to spot in places like this, where they stand out against the beige expanse.

Finding the rare rocks has become a popular pastime — and a business opportunity.

Driving from the Mauritanian capital to this remote Saharan outpost takes at least 18 hours, the last half on unmarked sandy

SEE METEORITES ON A10

Uncertainty about tariffs takes a toll on U.S. dollar

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

The U.S. dollar is an early casualty of President Donald Trump's us-against-the-world trade war.

The dollar has lost almost 10 percent of its value since Inauguration Day, with more than half of that decline coming this month after the president's decision to lift taxes on imported goods to their highest level since 1909.

The weaker dollar — now near

Investors flee greenback and Treasuries, usually seen in crises as a haven

a three-year low against the euro — is bad news for Americans traveling abroad and could also aggravate inflation by making foreign goods more expensive. U.S.

exporters, however, should gain.

The drop is especially striking because countries that impose tariffs usually see their currency rise. But the wobbly rollout of Trump's tariff plans — with the president and his aides contradicting themselves about key details — left investors doubting the administration's competence.

"The administration's approach to policy and its lack of transparency in terms of motiva-

tions have all led to a distinct sense of unease in financial markets," said David Page, head of macro research for Axa Investment Managers in London, which manages \$1 trillion in investments. "It doesn't look like what we have been used to in terms of well-thought-out policy."

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Fashion: Tariffs are a new reason to break your bad shopping habits. **C1**



MADELEINE HORDINSKI/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A Stellantis plant in Kokomo, Indiana. The town has lost many manufacturing jobs over the years.

Amid trade war, factory town waits for a boom

Tariffs have spelled layoffs in Kokomo, Indiana, but many there still hope they will lead to a rebound

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY

KOKOMO, IND. — Less than an hour after President Donald Trump unveiled sweeping "Liberation Day" tariffs on dozens of countries, Denny Butler, a United Auto Workers local union vice president, received word that Stellantis would temporarily lay off 370 of his members.

The maker of Chrysler, Dodge and Jeep brands explained that it was taking "immediate actions" because of the president's tariffs, which have hit the auto industry particularly hard.

Last week, company officials went into its three Kokomo plants searching for volunteers

before forcing some workers with less seniority to be laid off temporarily, Butler said. For now, the layoffs last only two weeks but could be extended, as they have been in the past. For some 470 Stellantis workers placed on indefinite layoffs last year, these new layoffs could further delay their return to work and even force them out of the industry.

"It's scary, and we don't know if it's going to stick," Butler said of the latest round of layoffs, as a procession of autoworkers dropped in to ask him for

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Tariffs' impact: China's online retailers face uncertainty. **A14**

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